

1. Executive Summary

Subject: Risk Assessment of Residence Hall Wi-Fi & RA Access **Date:** January 13, 2026

The Office of Residence Life utilizes a segmented network to manage student housing operations. This assessment evaluates risks associated with Resident Advisor (RA) access to the Student Information System (SIS) via dormitory Wi-Fi. The primary objective is to ensure compliance with the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) while maintaining operational efficiency. The assessment identified three critical risks related to unencrypted peer-to-peer traffic and physical hardware security.

2. Scope & Asset Inventory

- **Physical Scope:** "North Hall" Dormitory, RA Office, and Resident Rooms.
- **Assets:**
 - **Data:** Student PII (IDs, disciplinary records, room assignments - FERPA Protected).
 - **Hardware:** University-issued RA Laptops (Dell Latitude), Wireless Access Points (Aruba).
 - **Software:** "ResLife Portal" (Web-based SIS interface).

3. Threat Actors & Motivations

- **Inquisitive Students (Insider/Peer):** Motivated by curiosity, social engineering, or grade alteration.
- **Negligent RAs (Insider):** Motivated by convenience; lack of security awareness.
- **External Attackers:** Motivated by theft of PII for identity fraud.

4. Compliance Obligations

- **FERPA (34 CFR Part 99):** Mandates the protection of student education records. The university must use "reasonable methods" to ensure only authorized school officials (RAs) have access to legitimate educational interests.

5. Risk Assessment Matrix

Risk Rating Key: L=Likelihood (1-5), I=Impact (1-5), R=Risk Score (LxI).

Risk ID	Risk Description	Threat Source	Vulnerability	L	I	Score	Level
R-01	Wi-Fi Packet Sniffing	Student	Unencrypted traffic on "Guest" network	3	5	15	High
R-02	Unattended RA Device	Negligent RA	Lack of auto-lock/physical tether	4	4	16	High
R-03	Unauthorized Roommate Access	Student	Shared living space/Shared passwords	3	3	9	Med

6. Recommended Controls

- **Technical (R-01):** Enforce WPA3-Enterprise (802.1x) authentication for all RA devices; disable ResLife Portal access from the "Guest" SSID.
- **Physical/Technical (R-02):** Mandate 5-minute screen lock policies via Group Policy Object (GPO); issue laptop cable locks for RA desks.
- **Administrative (R-03):** Implement RA Confidentiality Agreement requiring distinct passwords; bi-annual FERPA handling training.

7. Business Impact Narrative

"If a student successfully intercepts disciplinary records via the dorm Wi-Fi, the university faces immediate reputational damage and potential Department of Education inquiries. Furthermore, a breach of trust between RAs and residents would undermine the Residence Life mission, potentially leading to a drop in on-campus housing retention."